OLD DOMINION UNIVERSITY
School of Cybersecurity

CYSE-200 Cybersecurity, Technology & Society

ONLINE SYLLABUS

Course Information

Course Title:	Cybersecurity, Technology & Society
Course Number:	200T
Credit Hours:	3
Semester/Year:	Fall 2026
ODUGlobal Session:	First Eight Weeks/Second Eight Weeks
Course Dates:	08/24/2026 - 10/16/2026
Delivery Format:	Asynchronous Online
Prerequisites:	None

Instructor Information

Instructor Name:	Chris Bowman
Email Address:	cbowman@odu.edu
Preferred Method of Communication:	email

Course Description

Students will explore how technology relates to cybersecurity from an interdisciplinary perspective. Attention is given to how technologically driven cybersecurity issues are connected to cultural, political, legal, ethical, and business domains.

After completing this course, students will be able to

1. Describe how cyber technology creates opportunities for criminal behavior.
2. Identify how cultural beliefs interact with technology to impact cybersecurity strategies.
3. Understand and practice sound business communication skills
4. Understand and describe how the components, mechanisms, and functions of cyber systems give rise to security concerns.
5. Discuss the impact of cyber technology on individuals' experiences of crime and victimization.

6. Understand and describe both intended and unintended ethical dilemmas that cybersecurity efforts produce for individuals, nations, societies, and the environment.
7. Describe the costs and benefits of producing secure cyber technologies.
8. Understand and describe the global nature of cybersecurity and the way that cybersecurity efforts have produced and inhibited global changes.
9. Describe the role of cybersecurity in defining appropriate and inappropriate behavior.
10. Describe how cybersecurity produces ideas of progress and modernism.

Required Course Materials

Open-access materials will be used in the course, all of which are available in Perusall. The primary textbook referenced throughout the course is Cybersecurity, Technology & Society, published by the course instructors at ODU.

Aldabagh, Bowman, Kirkpatrick, Oesteraas, and Yalpi. 2025. Self-Published.

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1tNmnrT7906K0DfkO-ZMopzU5mFOLza8H/view?usp=sharing

In addition, readings from various open-access journals and government reports will be included. All readings are listed in chronological order on Canvas > Syllabus.

Course Structure & Delivery

- This course is taught in an ONLINE format
- All resources needed for this class are found on Canvas, or will be provided in class

PLEASE NOTE THE FOLLOWING ITEMS THAT WILL IMPACT YOUR GRADE

1. Write-up assignments, sometimes called “journal entries,” are **graded 50% on professional business writing skills and 50% on your understanding of the content.** Please refer to the voicethread assignment concerning business writing skills to understand these requirements. In summary:
    a. Your name and date must appear at the top of the page
    b. The paper must have a clear and meaningful title (not “Assignment 3”)

   c. The paper must contain a clear and concise BLUF
   d. The paper must contain headings that guide the reader through your writing
   e. The paper must contain a clearly labeled conclusion
   f. The paper must have references and corresponding in-text citations as needed - APA format preferred
2. **Discussion Boards** are graded as follows.
   a. First, you should have a meaningful and substantial initial post about the topic. I'm looking for your opinion of the topic IN YOUR OWN WORDS.
   b. Second, you must provide at least two responses to fellow students' posts. These "follow-up" posts are to extend the conversation by agreeing with a fellow student AND adding additional context, OR taking exception to the comment AND providing a differing option. Put simply; you are to EXTEND the conversation.
3. **Assignments are due when they are due.** With the exception of discussion boards, later submissions are accepted up to 3 days late, but with a letter grade deduction for each day it is late. Due to the nature of the active participation of discussion boards, the due dates for these assignments are not extended.

Course Structure & Delivery

Online: This is a 100% online class with no scheduled meeting times. Classes are delivered through Canvas and other ODU-supported technologies. Students are expected to log in regularly, participate in online discussions or activities, and complete assignments by posted deadlines. Online courses require strong time-management and self-directed learning skills, with faculty available through virtual office hours and electronic communication.

Students should review the syllabus carefully to understand which format applies to their section and plan accordingly.

Class Schedule

CYSE-200T focuses on cybersecurity through multiple disciplinary lenses, comprising seven distinct modules. The core aim is to explore cybersecurity issues that are technologically driven yet connected to broader cultural, political, legal, ethical, and business domains. To succeed in this class, students are advised to maintain a positive attitude, demonstrate preparation, maintain presence (attendance), proactively contribute, and participate.

Week 1

Mod 1: Introductions: Class introductions and backgrounds.

Mod 2: The Interdisciplinary Nature of Cybersecurity: This module introduces the multi vs. transdisciplinary nature of cybersecurity, basic definitions, the roles of various disciplines, and security frameworks. Learning objectives include discussing key historical events and developing an understanding of the makeup of an "IT System" beyond just technology.

Week 2

Mod 3: Cybersec in Business: This module covers fundamental business concepts, including Operations, Finance, Marketing, Sales, IT, and Human Resources, and how Information Technology and Cybersecurity support these functions. It also explores Risk Management and Business Writing Skills, focusing on the concepts of and relationships between vulnerabilities, threats, exposures, and countermeasures.

Week 3

Mod 4: IT & BioCyber: This module focuses on an introduction to the Biological Sciences Industry, potential unique vulnerabilities in this field, and associated ethical considerations. Key topics include relating advances in biological research (e.g., CRISPR/Cas9 gene editing) to subsequent sections on philosophy and ethics, and discussing potential privacy concerns arising from these advancements.

Mod 5: Computer Science: Module 4 explores foundational technical concepts, including authentication, Authorization, Encryption Techniques, Attack Vectors, and Countermeasures. Objectives include explaining hashing mechanisms, exploring security terminology, and covering mechanisms such as firewalls and Virtual Private Networks (VPNs) used to protect systems.

Week 4

Mod 6: Engineering & Critical Infrastructure: This module discusses the impact of cyber technology and attacks on engineering systems, identifies common vulnerabilities in these systems, and describes fundamental design principles for resilience. It explicitly introduces Supervisory Control & Data Acquisition (SCADA) systems, which are used to manage critical infrastructure such as energy, agriculture, and transportation.

Week 5

Mod 7: Criminal Justice & Cybersecurity: The module examines the intersection of Criminal Justice and Cybersecurity, covering different types of cybercrime, the evolution of criminal justice with cyber technology, and shifting definitions of right and wrong. Topics addressed include cyber harassment, cyber stalking, and the challenges cybercrime poses to the justice system.

Week 6

Mod 8: Philosophy Aspects of Cybersecurity: This final module addresses the philosophical aspects of cybersecurity, focusing on questions like what is "Good/Bad for Society," societal responsibilities, and individual responsibilities. It examines ethical dilemmas, such as balancing business obligations with professional obligations to the public good, as well as the societal impact of technology.

Class Communication

Please do not email the instructor. I receive hundreds of emails daily, and it is impossible to keep up with them. Instead, use the Canvas messaging application. If your situation is time-sensitive, feel free to reach out via text (preferred) or voice call at any reasonable time. My mobile number is at the top of this document. If I do not answer, please send me a follow-up text, and I will get back to you as soon as possible.

COURSE REQUIREMENTS

Your final grade will be calculated using the following weighted categories.

	Weight
Voicethread, Reading & Discussion Board Participation	35%
Journal Write-Ups	20%
Misc. Assignments, including Quizzes & Analytical Paper	20%
Tests - Mid-Term & Final	25%
Total Points	100%

About Lecture Participation

Online lectures are recorded in VoiceThread, an online video “chat” tool. You are required to watch each of the VoiceThread lectures associated with each module and participate in class “discussions” by recording your comments as a video or audio. Additionally, Perusall is used to facilitate access to all reading materials for this class.

About VoiceThread

VoiceThread is used for asynchronous class discussions centered on media.

What Students Do

- View slides, images, or videos
- Respond with voice or video
- Engage directly with classmates' ideas

Why It Matters

- Encourages thoughtful, reflective participation
- Supports multiple communication styles
- Creates a sense of presence in online courses

Instructions for submitting audio, video, or other comments in a VoiceThread can be found here.

About Perusall

Perusall is used for all assigned readings.

What Students Do

- Read course materials online
- Highlight and annotate key passages
- Respond to peers directly in the text

Why It Matters

- Turns reading into an active, social process
- Promotes critical thinking and question-asking
- Makes student preparation visible and assessable

How They Work Together

- Perusall prepares students before class
- VoiceThread extends discussion beyond the reading
- Both tools emphasize engagement, not passive consumption

Grading

The final letter grade is based on the percentage of total points earned and will follow the suggested guidelines in the university catalog.

PCT Score	Letter Grade
94 - 100	A
90 - 93	A-
88 - 89	B+
84 - 87	B
80 - 83	B-
78 - 79	C+
74 - 78	C
70 - 73	C-
68 - 69	D+
64 - 68	D
<64	F

Assignments

Exams. Students will take two exams, both of which require lockdown browsers. Exams include multiple-choice, short-answer, and essay questions. Make-up exams are given only for pre-approved excused absences and must be done at the University Testing Lab located in the library.

Quizzes. Several readings are accompanied by a 10-question quiz worth 10 points. Quizzes are due the same week as their respective readings. Quizzes will remain available for 3 days after the due date. Grades are reduced by one point for each day past the due date. Quizzes not taken within the three-day grace period are assigned zeros. Additional assignments may fall under the quiz category.

Analytical Presentation. For this assignment, you will produce a presentation of cybersecurity-related technical systems' social meaning and impact. It'll be easier than it sounds. You'll produce a rough draft of most of the presentation by combining three journal entry assignments or reading entries you've already completed. After that, you'll edit and revise it so it presents smoothly, and then add a final section with a concluding analysis. In the end, you'll have a 5 - 7 slide presentation that draws from and combines work you've done throughout the course.

Technology and Cybersecurity Journal Entries (Write-Ups). On several weeks,

writing assignments or discussion board entries are required. The topic/questions to be answered are listed in the reading monitor. Students are expected to answer each question on their own. The professor will not remind the students each week to complete the questions. Throughout the semester, the professor will review and grade the entries to ensure they are up to date. Certain of these write-ups will be posted to your ePortfolio site.

Electronic Portfolio. Each student will maintain an ePortfolio describing their progress through the class. Integrate the assignments for this class into your ePortfolio. These assignments will include academic and reflective writing. In this class, you must either create or add to your ePortfolio (if you already have one). Your ePortfolio will allow you to include your educational goals, describe your extracurricular activities, and post your resume. In addition to the assignments, the e-Portfolio should include at least five photos depicting what you learned in class.

When you finish your time at ODU, your ePortfolio could become a multimedia showcase of your educational experience. If you would like in-person help with your ePortfolio, please visit https://www.odu.edu/ails/eportfolio/student-resources or schedule an appointment with an ePortfolio Assistant.

Submit your initial e-Portfolio by the assignment due date. You are responsible for updating the ePortfolio as you progress through the class. The instructor will evaluate the ePortfolio at the end of the semester based on these criteria: (1) inclusion of all assignments, (2) integration of academic and practical knowledge, (3) inclusion of required photos and videos, (4) clarity of ideas presented, and (5) inclusion of the video journal and free writes.

In the future, cybersecurity faculty and professionals may assess your ePortfolio internally as part of the program's efforts to evaluate success at ODU. Subsequent external reports, articles, and presentations arising from the evaluation will not identify specific students and will focus on summary measures of student learning outcomes.

Engagement Counts - Voicethread, Discussion Board & Reading Posts to be Graded

This participation/contribution grade is based on the content, depth, and quality of your contributions to the forum discussions, as outlined in the grading rubric. Contributions to discussion boards & readings represent 35% of your final grade. Consistent participation, thoughtful answers early in the week, and engagement in discussion with your peers will positively affect your overall grade.

The following are helpful hints to guide your successful participation in the discussion forum:

- It is important to develop and clearly convey your response to the discussion

topic.
- This is accomplished by starting early in the week (reading the assigned chapters or web articles)
- Learn more about the topic
- Ponder your findings
- Contribute more to the discussion
- Question your peers to gain depth in the discussion
- Respond thoughtfully to those who have questioned you
- Be willing to consider other opinions and contradictory information (ask questions to learn more about the opinions)
- Use good Netiquette
- Cite your references correctly
- Consider the following action: Discussion topics will be available on Monday and will close on Sunday at the end of the week. Log in to your course early in the week and try to post your initial discussion by mid-week. This will facilitate engagement by prompting a response to the initial posting. Your response to a peer should be more meaningful than "I agree." Instead, ask probing questions to elicit clarification or additional information to advance the discussion.

Course Expectations

Instructor Expectations

- I will ensure the accuracy of the course content.
- I will provide clear guidelines for course assignments.
- I will be available to answer your questions and provide meaningful feedback.
- I will do my best to create a rewarding learning experience for all students.
- I will follow fair and clear grading guidelines for all course assignments.
- I will do my best to prepare you for exams and assignments.

Student Expectations

- Attend all class meetings unless you have a valid reason for missing class.
- Spend an average of six (6) hours each week studying and preparing for class.
- Complete all course readings and assignments in a timely manner.
- Participate respectfully and thoughtfully in class and after-class discussions.
- Follow the ODU Honor Pledge.
- Do your best to succeed in this course.
- Contact me, your instructor, if you have any problems.

Attendance and Participation

All students are expected to attend all class sessions and participate fully in course activities. In an online setting, this means you are responsible for managing your time

to ensure you remain current with course content, readings, and engagement. The only excused absences are for official Old Dominion University travel and documented medical conditions. Absences due to work conflicts, deaths in the family, or other personal circumstances must be addressed through the Office of Student Affairs. Students are responsible for keeping up with all material, discussions, and assignments regardless of attendance.

Academic Dishonesty

Dishonesty (i.e., cheating) will not be tolerated. University procedures will be followed if academic dishonesty is discovered. The most common form of academic dishonesty is plagiarism. According to Section 3.F of the Student Disciplinary Policies and Procedures under the Student Code of Conduct:

"A student will have committed plagiarism if they reproduce someone else's work without acknowledging its source, or if the source is cited that the student has not cited or used (1998). Plagiarism includes submitting a research paper obtained from a commercial research service, the Internet, or from another student as if it were original work; making simple changes to borrowed materials while leaving the original content or phraseology intact; or copying material from a source, supplying proper documentation, but leaving out quotation marks (1998). Plagiarism also occurs in a group project if one or more of the group members do none of the group's work and participate in none of the group's activities but attempt to take credit for the work of the group (1996)." (http://orgs.odu.edu/hc/pages/plagiarism.shtml)

Student Opinion Survey

Student Opinion Surveys are an important tool for you to provide anonymous feedback at the end of a course about your instructors, course content, and your overall experience. In order to do so, you must log in to these tools with your MIDAS Account ID and Password. Please complete the student opinion survey at the end of the semester when you are prompted.

Disability Services. Students are encouraged to self-disclose disabilities, as verified by the Office of Educational Accessibility, and to provide Accommodation Letters to their instructors early in the semester to begin receiving accommodations. Accommodations will not be made until the Accommodation Letters are provided to instructors each semester.

Old Dominion University is committed to ensuring equal access to all qualified students with disabilities in accordance with the Americans with Disabilities Act. The Office of Educational Accessibility (OEA) is the campus office that serves students with disabilities by providing and arranging reasonable accommodations.

- If you have a disability that will affect your ability to access any aspect of my class, please provide the instructor with an accommodation letter from OEA so that we can work together to ensure appropriate accommodations are available to you.
- If you feel that you will experience barriers to your ability to learn and/or test in my class but do not have an accommodation letter, please consider scheduling an appointment with OEA to determine if academic accommodations are necessary.

The Office of Educational Accessibility is located at 1021 Student Success Center and its phone number is (757)683-4655. Additional information is available at the OEA website: http://www.odu.edu/educationalaccessibility/